IONUT GRAD

Software Engineer

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Cluj-Napoca, Romania

EDUCATION

- 2021 - Master's Degree at Babes-Bolyai University
- 2019 - Bachelor's degree at Babes-Bolyai University

SKILLS

- React & Typescript
- Java & Spring
- SQL Databases
- REST & Apollo GraphQL
- Kafka
- AWS

LANGUAGES

- Romanian - Native
- English - C1

ABOUT ME

Full-stack software engineer with 7 years of experience building reliable and scalable applications using **React**, **TypeScript**, **Java**, **Spring**, and **AWS**. I focus on writing clean, efficient code and enjoy solving real-world problems with practical solutions. Looking for new remote contract roles where I can contribute to interesting and meaningful projects.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Oct 2022 - Present: **IT Teams - Fullstack Engineer**

- I'm currently collaborating with a leading Austrian energy solutions provider to modernize and scale their enterprise platform using **React**, **TypeScript**, **Java**, **Kotlin**, **Spring Boot**, **GraphQL**, **Kafka**, and **AWS**, driving major improvements in performance, usability, and developer efficiency.
- Redesigned the front-end architecture, migrating legacy **Predix** components to **MUI**, which significantly improved UI consistency, accessibility, and responsiveness. Resulted in a 50% faster rendering time and a more modern, maintainable component library.
- Replaced **Webpack** with **Vite** for the front-end build process, achieving two times faster development server startup and drastically reduced build times, accelerating the CI/CD pipeline and improving developer productivity.
- Built and maintained microservices in **Java** and **Kotlin**, integrating critical business flows with **Salesforce** and **Oracle** systems. Ensured scalability and fault tolerance through modular service design and asynchronous communication using **Apache Kafka** for event-driven architecture and reliable message streaming between services.
- Improved system scalability and cloud deployment workflows by working extensively with **AWS** services, including provisioning and managing **EC2** instances, deploying containerized services via **Docker** and **Kubernetes Pods**, leveraging **S3** for asset storage, and streamlining CI/CD pipelines using **GitHub Actions** and **ArgoCD** for automated multi-environment deployments.
- Led key initiatives to optimize backend performance and reduce latency, such as database indexing, **GraphQL** query optimization, and asynchronous data fetching, which collectively resulted in a 30–40% improvement in API response times under production load.

Apr 2021- Oct 2022: **Zenitech - Frontend Engineer**

- Contributed to the development of a global employee engagement platform for a UK-based company, using **React**, **TypeScript**, and **GraphQL** to build highly interactive, modular features optimized for large-scale, multi-tenant environments.
- Improved front-end performance by over **40%** by refactoring **GraphQL** queries to reduce over-fetching and implementing Apollo Client caching strategies. Also optimized React rendering through **memoization** and fine-grained state management.
- Partnered closely with product and design teams to improve user experience, which led to a 20% increase in user task completion rates and a noticeable reduction in support tickets.
- Played a key role in scaling the product globally, adapting the platform for multilingual and region-specific use cases, and contributing to its successful expansion into new markets across Europe, North America, and Asia.

Jul 2018- Apr 2021: **Micro Focus - Fullstack Engineer**

- Engineered core features of a scalable Robotic Process Automation (RPA) platform using **Java**, **Spring Boot**, **React**, and **TypeScript**, enabling enterprise clients to automate complex workflows and reduce manual effort by up to 35%.
- Improved system performance by over 20% by optimizing **JPA** queries and introduced batch processing to reduce N+1 query problems, introducing **Redis** caching, and implementing asynchronous job execution via message queues (**RabbitMQ**), resulting in faster task orchestration and reduced infrastructure costs
- Enhanced front-end responsiveness by integrating code-splitting, **WebSocket**-based real-time updates, and React optimization techniques (**React.memo, useCallback**), cutting load times by up to 15% and streamlining user interaction with workflow editors.